# Pablo Villar-Abeijón

pablo.villar@uab.cat

## 1. RESEARCH INTERESTS

Gentrification; Socio-spatial inequalities; Housing affordability; Urban segregation; Quantitative socio-spatial analysis; Urban policy; Mobility; Sustainable urban transformations.

## 2. CURRENT POSITION

Doctoral Researcher (FI Joan Oró Fellowship) at Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (2024–present). PhD research on gentrification, neighbourhood change and housing affordability, examining the unintended effects of urban interventions through quantitative spatial analysis and quasi-experimental methods.

## 3. EDUCATION

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| **2024 - 2027** | **Ph.D. in Geography** |
| | University: Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (Spain) |
| | Supervisors: Oriol **Marquet**; Carme **Miralles-Guasch** |
| | **Thesis title**: Proximity-Driven Gentrification: The Unintended Effects of Active Mobility Infrastructure on Population, Commercial and Housing Shifts. |
| **2022 - 2023** | **MA in Territorial Studies and Planning** |
| | University: Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (Spain) |
| **2018 - 2022** | **BA in Political Science and Public Administration** |
| | University: Universidade de Santiago de Compostela (Spain) |
| | **Extraordinary End-of-Degree Award** (Ranked 1st in the graduating class) |
| | Erasmus exchange year: **Sciences Po Lyon** – Certificat d'Études Politiques. |

## 4. RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

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| **Research methods** | Quantitative urban analysis; quasi-experimental methods; neighbourhood change analysis. |
| **Spatial analysis** | Spatial statistics; geospatial visualization; GIS-based urban analysis. |
| **Software** | R, Stata, SPSS, QGIS, ArcGIS Pro, GeoDa. |

**Pablo Villar-Abeijón**
September 2026

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ORCID: 0009-0007-6111-2638

## 5. VISITING POSITIONS

**Fall 2025** Visiting Fellow, **Université de Montréal** (Canada), Centre de Recherche en Santé Publique (CReSP).

## 6. ACADEMIC POSITIONS

**2023 - 2024** **Research Support Specialist**
Geography Department, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (Spain).

Spatial data analysis and research support in urban and transport geography projects.

## 7. PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

**Villar-Abeijón, P.** & Rodríguez-Barcón, A. (2026). Xentrificación na Galicia urbana: unha proposta metodolóxica para cidades medianas aplicada á Coruña, Santiago de Compostela e Vigo. *Scripta Nova. Revista Electrónica de Geografía y Ciencias Sociales.* 30(3). doi: 10.1344/sn2026.30.53466. **Q3 in Geography, Planning and Development (SJR)**

Mombelli, S., Cubells, J., **Villar-Abeijón, P.**, & Marquet, O. (2026). Media framing and political discourse of Barcelona's urban transformations (2016–2024). *Cities*, 179, 107443. doi: 10.1016/j.cities.2026.107443. **Q1/D1 in Urban Studies (SJR).**

**Villar Abeijón, P.**, Fernández Núñez, M. B., & Marquet, O. (2026). Perceived vs. objective gentrification: Bridging measurements of neighborhood change. *Journal of Urban Affairs*, 1–26. doi: 10.1080/07352166.2026.2638887. **Q1 in Urban Studies (SJR).**

**Villar Abeijón, P.**, Miralles-Guasch, C., & Marquet, O. (2026). The effects of pedestrianization on commercial dynamics a quasi-experimental study in Barcelona. *Applied Geography*, 189, 103947. doi: 10.1016/j.apgeog.2026.103947. **Q1/D1 in Geography, Planning and Development (SJR).**

**Villar Abeijón, P.**, Miralles-Guasch, C., & Marquet, O. (2026). The impact of proximity to amenities on housing affordability: Insights from Mediterranean 15-minute cities. *Cities*, 172, 106859. doi: 10.1016/j.cities.2026.106859. **Q1/D1 in Urban Studies (SJR).**

**Villar Abeijón, P.**, Miralles Guasch, C., & Marquet Sardà, O. (2025). Can pedestrianization trigger gentrification? *Transportation Research Part D: Transport and Environment*, 142, 104718. doi: 10.1016/j.trd.2025.104718. **Q1/D1 in Transportation (SJR).**

## 8. PARTICIPATION IN FUNDED RESEARCH PROJECTS

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| **2024 - 2028** | **European Commission (ERC Starting Grant)**; *ATRAPA: The active travel backlash paradox: opposition and acceptability determinants of built environment-based sustainable travel interventions*. Type of participation: **researcher** (1,500,000€). |
| **2026 - 2028** | **Ministry of Science and Innovation (Spain)**; *FUTURBAN: Mapeando el Futuro: Herramientas Interactivas para la Planificación Urbana Prospectiva*. Type of participation: **research collaborator** (242,000€). |
| **2022 - 2024** | **Ministry of Science and Innovation (Spain)**; *MOVACT 1.0 – Territorios para la movilidad activa en España. Desarrollo del Atlas MOVACT 1.0.* Proyectos de I+D+i – Pruebas de Concepto. Type of participation: **contracted research assistant** (175,000€). |

## 9. TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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| **2026** | *Geographical Visions of the World* (Teaching assistant)<br>Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona. (Spain)<br>Delivered **lectures and practical classes**. |
| **2025** | *Urban Policies: Housing, Neighborhoods and Transport* (Teaching assistant)<br>Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona. (Spain)<br>Delivered **practical classes**. |

## 10. CONFERENCES' PRESENTATIONS

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| **2026** | World Planning Schools Congress (**WPSC**) 2026, Helsinki (Finland). |
| **2025** | Association of European Schools of Planning (**AESOP**) Annual Congress, Istanbul (Türkiye). |
| **2025** | European Network for Housing Research (**ENHR**), Grand Paris (France). |
| **2024** | Association of European Schools of Planning (**AESOP**) Annual Congress, Paris (France). |
| **2024** | Urban Transitions, Sitges (Spain). |
| **2024** | International Conference Association of People-Environment Studies (IAPS), Barcelona (Spain). |

## 11. LANGUAGES

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| **Spanish**: | Native |
| **Galician**: | Native |
| **English**: | Full professional proficiency (C2) |
| **French**: | Full professional proficiency (C2) |

**Catalan**: Full professional proficiency (C1)

## 12. SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS AND AWARDS

**2024** PhD Joan Oró Fellowship (FI-AGAUR), Catalan Government (Spain).

**2022** End-of-Degree Excellence Award (*Premio Fin de Carreira*), Galician Government (Spain).

## 13. SELECTED ADDITIONAL TRAINING

**2026** ***World Planning Schools Congress – PhD Workshop***. Tampere University (Finland). Duration: 80 hours.

**2025** ***Demography of Catalonia***. Centre for Demographic Studies (CED), Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona & Government of Catalonia (Spain). Duration: 8 hours.

**2024** ***Geographic Information Systems in Applied Economics***. Fiscal Studies Institute (Spain). Duration: 20 hours.

**2024** ***Advanced Course in Geographic Information Systems*** *(ArcGIS Pro*). National Geographic Institute (IGN), Ministry of Transport and Sustainable Mobility (Spain). Duration: 40 hours.

## 14. SUPERVISION EXPERIENCE

**2026** **Master's Thesis.** *Commercial Gentrification: A Qualitative Analysis of Aesthetic Markers in Pedestrianized and Non-Pedestrianized Streets in Barcelona.* **Raquel Torres Aponte**. Co-supervised with Oriol Marquet.

MA in Interdisciplinary Studies in Environmental, Economic and Social Sustainability. Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (UAB).

## 15. PEER REVIEW ACTIVITY

**Journal reviewer**

*Cities & Health.* Elsevier (1)

*Spatial Demography*. Springer Nature (1)

*Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy*. Springer Nature (1)

*Discover Cities*. Springer Nature (1)